

CHARITABLE ASSISTANCE, BANKING AND SOCIAL MEDIA/MARKETING POLICIES

CHARITABLE ASSISTANCE POLICY

King Solomon Lodge No. 6

Effective Date: []

Purpose

This policy establishes the procedures under which the Organization may provide limited charitable financial assistance to individuals. All assistance is secondary to the Organization's primary fraternal purposes and is provided exclusively as a public charitable activity in furtherance of the Organization's exempt purposes under IRC § 501(c)(10). Assistance can only be provided to members or their dependents, by applying this same policy, otherwise it would constitute a prohibited "benefit."

IRS Compliance and Protection of Tax-Exempt Status

A 501(c)(10) organization must devote its net earnings exclusively to religious, charitable, scientific, literary, educational, and fraternal purposes. Without a clear, objective process, any distribution of funds could be viewed by the IRS as private benefit, inurement, or an impermissible "other benefit" to members, which is strictly prohibited and could result in revocation of our tax-exempt status.

Objective and Consistent Decision-Making

Written rules and a standardized review checklist prevent favoritism, personal bias, or ad-hoc decisions. They ensure every request is evaluated fairly and based on the same criteria, protecting the integrity of the Lodge's charitable work.

Legal Protection for Officers and Members

Lodge officers and members of the organization are personally liable, therefore we have a fiduciary duty to act lawfully. Formal documentation creates a clear record that we follow established procedures. This shields individuals from personal civil or federal liability if the IRS or any authority ever reviews our activities.

Audit-Ready Records

The IRS may request records at any time. Having complete files (applications, checklists, supporting documents, and payment proofs) demonstrates that our charitable assistance is a legitimate public-benefit activity and not disguised private aid.

Lodge Governance and Member Confidence

Clear policies allow the Lodge to continue charitable work safely and confidently while keeping our primary focus on fraternal purposes. They also prevent future misunderstandings or disputes about how funds are used.

Protection of the Grand Lodge and All Subordinate Lodges

Our ability to have this 501(c)(10) classification is based on the previous document titled (HOW 501 © (10) Legally Operates). Any breach of law on our end could trigger a wider audit to include the Grand Lodge and potentially ALL other subordinate lodges.

By following this Policy which is based on the IRS Rules of ALL 501 (C) (10) organizations and its attached exhibits, we remain fully compliant, protect the Lodge, and fulfill our charitable mission in a lawful and fraternal manner.

Eligibility

Assistance is available only to persons who demonstrate:

1. Genuine financial hardship or distress;
2. Income at or below 250% of the current Federal Poverty Guidelines and
3. That the assistance will relieve a specific, verifiable need (e.g., overdue rent, utilities, medical bills).

Exclusions

- No assistance for non-essential expenses (credit cards, entertainment, loans, fines, etc.).
- No loans or repayable aid — all assistance is a one-time charitable grant.

Application and Verification Process

All requests for relief, financial assistance, donations, sponsorships, or any form of charitable aid must be submitted directly to the Charity Committee. This includes current members of the Lodge, family members or close acquaintances.

Important Rule:

No individual member, officer, or committee is authorized to accept, approve, or handle any request for aid. Unless it is money tendered from your purse as you have been called to do. Every request — without exception — must be immediately turned over to the Charity Committee for review and processing. Requests received by anyone else should be politely redirected to the Committee with a copy of this policy.

This centralized process ensures

- Fair and consistent evaluation of every request
- Proper documentation and accountability
- Efficient use of charitable resources
- Full compliance with our organization's guidelines

Thank you for helping us maintain transparency and integrity in our relief efforts.

- Applicants must complete the official Benevolence / Hardship Assistance Application Form and submit all required supporting documentation.
- The Charity Committee will review each application.
- The Committee will verify the need through:
 - Review of the bill/invoice
 - Proof of income and household expenses
 - Any other reasonable documentation the Committee deems necessary
- Decisions are made by majority vote of the Committee and recorded in writing.

Approval Limits and Payment

- Maximum grant: \$500.00 per household per calendar year
- All payments will be made directly to the creditor/vendor (never to the individual).
- The Organization will issue the check or electronic payment in the name of the creditor with a memo noting "charitable assistance – [applicant's last name]."

Record Keeping

A complete file will be maintained for each request for at least seven (7) years, including:

- Completed application
- All supporting documents

- Committee decision and rationale
- Proof of payment

These records will be available for IRS audit or Form 990 review.

Conflict of Interest

No officer, or member may participate in the review or approval of an application if they have a personal or family relationship with the applicant. This includes any voting on distribution of funds. All such relationships must be disclosed in writing.

Reporting

The Charity Committee will provide a quarterly summary report to the membership listing the number of applications received, approved, and denied, total dollars disbursed, and any trends or concerns.

Amendment

The Jurisprudence Committee shall conduct an annual review of the Charitable Assistance Policy. Any changes to the Policy or its exhibits that are required solely because of changes in local, state, or federal law, the Internal Revenue Code, Treasury Regulations, or IRS guidance may be adopted immediately by the lodge without a vote of the membership. The Jurisprudence Committee shall notify the membership of any such changes at the next regular stated meeting.

Custody of Policy

The Secretary of the Lodge shall hold and maintain the official copy of the Charitable Assistance Policy and all attached exhibits. The Secretary shall make the current Policy and exhibits available for review by any member of the Lodge upon reasonable request.

Disclaimer

This program is entirely discretionary. The Organization reserves the right to deny any request for any reason. Assistance is not guaranteed and does not create any legal right or entitlement.

BANKING ACCOUNTS POLICY

King Solomon Lodge No. 6

Effective Date: []

Purpose

This Policy establishes clear guidelines for the management, funding, use, and oversight of the Lodge's four bank accounts to ensure financial transparency, compliance with our 501(c)(10) status allowing proper separation of funds, and adherence to Masonic principles and our Bylaws. All officers, trustees, and members with financial responsibilities must follow this policy.

Account Structure

The Lodge maintains four distinct accounts:

- Monthly Operations Fund (General Fund)
- Charity Fund
- Knife and Fork Club Fund
- Savings and Investments Fund

MONTHLY OPERATIONS ACCOUNT

Purpose: To cover the day-to-day operations of the Lodge. Funding Sources (Inflows):

- Member's dues
- Rental income
- Occasional donations specifically noted for this account (non-charitable)

Authorized Uses (Outflows):

- All normal operating expenses (rent, utilities, supplies, officer stipends, etc.)

Transfers:

- Excess funds may be transferred to the Savings and Investments Fund.
- Funds may be transferred from the Savings and Investments Fund only in the event of an emergency shortfall in monthly operations. Any such transfer requires a Lodge vote (or at minimum, formal notice to the Lodge at the next stated communication).

CHARITY ACCOUNT

Purpose

To provide charitable relief and support in accordance with Masonic tradition and our 501(c)(10) tax-exempt status. Funding Sources (Inflows):

- Charitable donations
- Proceeds from fundraisers
- Any other income that qualifies under 501(c)(10) rules (e.g., certain grants or designated gifts)
- Transfers from the Knife and Fork Club Fund (excess of over \$400)
- Earmarked donations for specific initiatives (e.g., Christmas for Kids fund)
- Note: Donations specifically to the Charity Account are tax deductible (See IRS, IRC 170(C)(4)).

Authorized Uses (Outflows):

- Approved community charitable causes
- Earmarked donations for specific initiatives (e.g., Christmas for Kids Fund)
- Support of 501(C)(3) Organizations Relief of the poor, distressed, or underprivileged
- Advancement of religion, education, or science
- Erection or maintenance of public buildings, monuments, or works
- Lessening the burdens of government
- Promotion of social welfare by lessening neighborhood tensions, eliminating prejudice and discrimination, defending human and civil rights, or combating community deterioration and juvenile delinquency

In short, charity means activities that provide public benefit and serve the general welfare or a charitable class of people, without private inurement (no net earnings benefiting private individuals).

Restrictions:

- This fund may not be used for general Lodge operating expenses or any other expenses other than properly reviewed Charitable purposes.
- All expenditures must comply with 501(c)(10) regulations to maintain tax-exempt status.

Important restriction on for-profit businesses:

- It is not permitted (and would jeopardize your 501(c)(10) tax-exempt status) to make a direct donation, grant, or charitable contribution specifically to a for-profit business. Such a payment would constitute a private benefit to the business owners rather than serving a public charitable purpose. IRS rules prohibit tax-exempt organizations from using their net earnings in any manner to benefit private for-profit entities. Money can flow from a for-profit to your organization (e.g., a business can sponsor or donate to you), but never the other way around as charity.

KNIFE AND FORK CLUB ACCOUNT

Purpose

To support the social and dining activities of the Knife and Fork Club as a subcommittee of the Lodge. Funding Sources (Inflows):

- Dining collections and donations from Knife and Fork Club events
- Transfer from Monthly Operations Fund when the balance falls below \$400.00
- Note: Please refer to the by-laws for specific information

Authorized Uses (Outflows):

- Dinner expenses, event costs, and related social activities of the Knife and Fork Club

Balance Rule:

- The account shall maintain a target minimum balance of \$400.
- Monthly Reset: At the end of each month:
 - Any balance over \$400 shall be transferred to the Charity Fund.

- Any balance under \$400 shall be replenished from the Monthly Operations Fund to bring it back to \$400.

SAVINGS AND INVESTMENT ACCOUNT

Purpose

To serve as a reserve for major building-related emergencies and, secondarily, to cover Monthly Operations shortfalls.

Funding Sources (Inflows):

- Transfers from the Monthly Operations Fund (excess cash)

Authorized Uses (Outflows):

- Large emergency building needs only (primary purpose)
- Emergency shortfalls in Monthly Operations (secondary use, with required Lodge approval/notice as noted in Section 3)
- Lodge approved Investment including (CD's, Mutual Funds, Money Manager etc.)

Restrictions

- This fund shall not be used for routine operations, social events, charity or any non-emergency or investment purpose.

Compliance

This policy ensures compliance with our 501(c)(10) status for the Charity Fund and maintains clear separation of funds as required for fraternal organizations.

Amendment

The Jurisprudence Committee shall conduct an annual review of the Banking Accounts Policy. Any changes to the Policy or its exhibits that are required solely because of changes in local, state, or federal law, the Internal Revenue Code, Treasury Regulations, or IRS guidance may be adopted immediately by the lodge without a vote of the membership. The Jurisprudence Committee shall notify the membership of any such changes at the next regular stated meeting.

Custody of Policy

The Secretary of the Lodge shall hold and maintain the official copy of the Banking Accounts Policy and all attached exhibits. The Secretary shall make the current Policy and exhibits available for review by any member of the Lodge upon reasonable request.

SOCIAL MEDIA AND MARKETING POLICY

King Solomon Lodge No. 6

Effective Date: []

Purpose

To protect the Lodge's 501(c)(10) tax-exempt status through controlled, accurate, and compliant public communications and marketing. Only officially approved social media outlets and marketing channels may be used for any Lodge business, events, or promotions.

Exclusive Responsibility of the Social Media/Marketing Committee:

The Social Media/Marketing Committee is solely responsible for designing, creating, approving, printing, posting, or otherwise distributing:

- All advertisements
- Posters
- Tickets
- Flyers
- Social media content
- Any other promotional or marketing materials related to the Lodge or its events

The social media/ marketing committee is to create and distribute these materials and follow all applicable laws regarding 501 (C) (10) rules and regulations.

Prohibition on Individual Action

No individual member, officer, or other committee shall independently create and post any official Lodge promotional content, event information, or marketing materials without the prior approval of the Social Media/Marketing Committee.

Members are encouraged to share official marketing on their own private pages, groups etc.

This rule exists to prevent unintentional violations, misleading information, or non-compliant communications that could risk revocation of our 501(c)(10) status or create other liability for the Lodge. Compliance: All marketing and communications must align with the charitable and fraternal purposes of a 501(c)(10) organization.

Amendment

The Jurisprudence Committee shall conduct an annual review of the Social Media and Marketing Policy. Any changes to the Policy or its exhibits that are required solely because of changes in local, state, or federal law, the Internal Revenue Code, Treasury Regulations, or IRS guidance may be adopted immediately by the lodge without a vote of the membership. The

Jurisprudence Committee shall notify the membership of any such changes at the next regular stated meeting.

Custody of Policy

The Secretary of the Lodge shall hold and maintain the official copy of the Social Media and Marketing Policy and all attached exhibits. The Secretary shall make the current Policy and exhibits available for review by any member of the Lodge upon reasonable request.

EXHIBIT A –CHARITY COMMITTEE REVIEW CHECKLIST

For King Solomon Lodge No.6

Application #: _____ Date Received: _____

Applicant's Last Name: _____ Committee Members Present:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Every item must be checked YES (or N/A) before funds can be released. Attach this checklist to the completed application form and all supporting documents.

#	Item to Verify	YES	NO	N/A	Notes / Action Needed
1	Applicant is not a current or former member and is not an immediate family member of any member	☐	☐	☐	
2	Completed Benevolence / Hardship Assistance Application Form is on file	☐	☐	☐	
3	Copy of the current overdue bill/invoice is attached	☐	☐	☐	
4	Proof of income (pay stubs, tax return, unemployment, etc.) is attached	☐	☐	☐	
5	Proof of hardship (bank statements or other documentation) is attached	☐	☐	☐	
6	Household income is at or below 200% of current Federal Poverty Guidelines	☐	☐	☐	Income verified: \$_____
7	Expense is for an eligible purpose (rent, utilities, medical, etc.)	☐	☐	☐	
8	All conflicts of interest have been disclosed and conflicted member(s) recused	☐	☐	☐	
9	Committee reviewed the application and supporting documents	☐	☐	☐	
10	Majority vote of the Committee: Approved ☐ Denied ☐	☐	☐	☐	Vote tally: ____ / ____

11 Amount approved does not exceed the annual maximum per household ☐ ☐ ☐ Amount approved: \$_____

12 Payment will be made directly to the creditor (never to the applicant) ☐ ☐ ☐ Creditor: _____

Decision Rationale (required):

Payment Details (only if approved)

Check/EFT # _____ Date Paid: _____ Amount: \$_____

Committee Certification

We certify that all required steps have been completed in accordance with the Charitable Assistance Policy. Signatures (at least 3 required):

1. _____ Date: _____ Printed Name: _____

2. _____ Date: _____ Printed Name: _____

3. _____ Date: _____ Printed Name: _____

EXHIBIT B – CHARITY ASSISTANCE DENIAL LETTER

Use King Solomon Lodge No. 6 Letterhead

[Date]

[Applicant's Name]

[Applicant's Address]

Dear [Applicant's First Name],

Thank you for submitting your Hardship Assistance Application dated [date of application]. After careful review by the Charity Committee using the Organization's official Charitable Assistance Policy and Review Checklist, your request for assistance has not been approved at this time.

The Organization's charitable assistance program is limited and entirely discretionary. We receive more requests than we are able to fund, and all decisions are made based on the objective criteria set forth in our written policy.

We appreciate your understanding and wish you the best in resolving your current situation. You are welcome to reapply in the future if your circumstances change and you still meet the eligibility requirements. If you have any questions about the policy itself, please feel free to contact [Name & Title] at [phone/email].

Sincerely, [Name of Committee Chair or Secretary]

Charity Committee

King Solomon Lodge No.6

info@ksl6.org

EXHIBIT C – Qualifying Hardship Examples

(For Charity Committee Use)

The IRS defines charitable assistance as relief of the poor, distressed, or underprivileged. Below are common examples of situations that generally qualify. These are illustrative only — every application must still be reviewed using the full Application Form and Exhibit A Checklist with objective documentation.

Poor (Chronic Low Income / Financially Needy)

- Household income at or below 250% of federal poverty guidelines (currently
- Working poor families unable to cover basic living expenses
- Elderly or disabled individuals on fixed income (Social Security, SSI, etc.)
- Single-parent households with high essential costs relative to income

Distressed (Temporary or Sudden Crisis)

- Sudden job loss or reduction in hours causing inability to pay rent or utilities
- Major unexpected medical bills or serious illness/injury
- Natural disaster, fire, flood, or home damage
- Victims of crime, domestic violence, or abuse
- Death of a primary wage-earner or divorce/separation creating immediate hardship
- Unexpected major car repair that prevents the person from getting to work

Underprivileged (Vulnerable or Disadvantaged Groups)

- Elderly people struggling with rising costs of living
- Disabled individuals needing help with medical or daily living expenses
- Refugees or recent immigrants facing immediate financial barriers
- Formerly incarcerated individuals re-entering society with urgent needs
- Youth or young adults from disadvantaged backgrounds needing educational support

What Does NOT Qualify

- Requests from individuals with adequate resources or income
- Non-essential expenses (credit cards, entertainment, vacations, luxury items)
- Ongoing or repeated aid without new proof of continued hardship
- Any request from a current or former member or their immediate family (Unless they qualify the same way any other individual would)

Committee Guidance

When reviewing an application, ask: “Does the documentation show this person is objectively poor, in genuine distress, or underprivileged, and will this one-time payment relieve that specific need?” If the answer is clearly yes and all other checklist items are satisfied, the request is within bounds.

EXHIBIT D - 2026 FEDERAL POVERTY GUIDELINES AND 250% THRESHOLD – STATE OF TENNESSEE

The 2026 Federal Poverty Guidelines (also known as the Federal Poverty Level or FPL) are issued annually by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), Office of the Assistant Secretary for Planning and Evaluation (ASPE). Tennessee uses the guidelines for the 48 contiguous states and the District of Columbia.

The table below sets forth the 100% FPL amounts and the corresponding 250% FPL amounts

Household Size	100% FPL (Annual)	250% FPL (Annual)
1	\$15,960	\$39,900
2	\$21,640	\$54,100
3	\$27,320	\$68,300
4	\$33,000	\$82,500
5	\$38,680	\$96,700
6	\$44,360	\$110,900
7	\$50,040	\$125,100
8	\$55,720	\$139,300

(i.e., the income level at or below which a household qualifies under a 250% FPL threshold). These figures are gross annual income amounts before taxes and are effective as of January 13, 2026.

Citation / Official Source:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, “Annual Update of the HHS Poverty Guidelines,” Federal Register, Vol. 91, No. 11 (January 15, 2026),

Household size includes the filer plus spouse and all dependents claimed on the most recent federal tax return.

These amounts apply only to the State of Tennessee.

Eligibility for programs using a 250% FPL threshold is generally met when household gross annual income is at or below the amounts shown in the right-hand column.

